

- **Date:** 2024 but timeless in its bias.
- **Appearance:** Poor formatting, emotive language, no citations.
- **Reason:** To persuade and inflame emotion. **Verdict:** Poor source.

Which is better and why:

The journal article is far better for academic use. It passes all RADAR criteria: it is relevant, authoritative, current, professional, and aims to inform based on evidence. The blog post fails on authority, appearance, and reason—it is opinion-based, biased, and lacks credible support. Academic writing requires credible evidence, not anecdotal or ideological claims.

Task 3: Reflect

Spotting fallacies and evaluating sources with RADAR are two sides of the same critical thinking coin. Fallacy detection helps me ensure *my own* logic is sound, while RADAR helps me ensure the *evidence* I use is sound. In research, even if my logic is perfect, if my sources are flawed (e.g., based on fallacies themselves), my entire argument collapses. Together, these skills create a robust filter: first I filter out my own logical errors, then I filter out unreliable external information. This dual process is what separates casual opinion from rigorous academic argument.

Chapter 6: The Thesis: The Engine of All Essays

第六章：论文陈述：所有文章的核心 (Lùnwén chénnshù: Suǒyǒu wénzhāng de héxīn)

Your Goal for This Chapter 本章目标 (Běn zhāng mùbiāo): To craft a strong, arguable thesis statement that acts as the central argument and controlling idea for any type of essay.

为任何类型的文章构建一个强大的、可论证的论文陈述，将其作为中心论点和核心思想。

Lesson 6.1: What is a Thesis?

第一课：什么是论文陈述？(Shénme shì lùnwén chénnshù?)

Part 1: The Engine of Your Essay

文章的核心引擎 (Wénzhāng de héxīn yǐnqíng)

If your essay were a car, the **thesis statement 论文陈述 (lùnwén chénnshù)** would be the engine. Every single part of your essay—every paragraph, every piece of evidence—connects to and is powered by this one central sentence. Without a strong thesis, your essay won't go anywhere.

A thesis is more than just a statement of fact; it is a **claim 主张 (zhǔzhāng)** that needs to be proven. It is the main argument you will support with evidence throughout your entire paper.

A Fact 事实 (Shìshí): "The Great Depression was a severe global economic downturn that began in 1929."

A Thesis 论文陈述 (Lùnwén chénnshù): "The primary cause of the Great Depression was not the stock market crash itself, but the widespread bank failures that wiped out the life savings of millions of Americans and crushed consumer confidence."

Part 2: The Formula for a Strong Thesis

强大论文陈述的公式 (Qiángdà lùnwén chénnshù de gōngshì)

A strong thesis statement usually has three key parts:

一个强大的论文陈述通常包含三个关键部分：

1. **The Topic 主题 (Zhǔtí):** What are you writing about?
你要写什么？

2. **Your Position/Claim 你的立场/主张 (Nǐ de lìchǎng/zhǔzhāng):** What is your main argument about the topic?
你关于这个主题的主要论点是什么？
3. **The Rationale (The "Because") 理由 (“因为”) (Lǐyóu (“Yīnwèi”)):** What are the main reasons that support your claim?
This provides a roadmap for your essay.
支持你主张的主要理由是什么？这为你的文章提供了路线图。

Thesis Statement - Formula 公式:

Topic + Position + Rationale = Strong Thesis

主题 + 立场 + 理由 = 强大的论文陈述

Weak 薄弱: "This paper is about social media." (This is only a topic.)

Strong 强大: "While social media connects people, it ultimately harms teenage mental health *because it promotes unrealistic comparisons, enables cyberbullying, and disrupts sleep patterns.*"

“虽然社交媒体连接了人们，但它最终危害青少年心理健康，因为它助长了不切实际的比较、使网络欺凌成为可能，并破坏了睡眠模式。”

How to Use the Formula: A Step-by-Step Guide

Follow these steps to build your own thesis statement from the ground up.

Step 1: Start with a Broad Topic

Begin with the general subject you want to write about.

- **Example Topic:** Social media

Step 2: Narrow it Down with a Specific Claim

Ask a question about your topic and form an opinion. This is your argument or position.

- **Question:** Is social media good or bad for teenagers?
- **Your Position:** It is more harmful than helpful.
- **Combined so far:** Social media has a net negative impact on adolescents.

Step 3: Add the "Because" (The Rationale)

This is the most crucial step. List the key points or reasons that prove your claim. These will become the main body paragraphs of your essay.

- **Reasons:** It promotes social comparison, enables cyberbullying, and disrupts sleep patterns.
- **Add the Rationale:** ...because it promotes social comparison, enables cyberbullying, and disrupts sleep patterns.

Step 4: Combine and Refine

Bring all three parts together into one or two clear, complete sentences. Use transition words to make it flow smoothly.

Final Thesis Statement:

Although social media helps teens stay connected, it ultimately has a net negative impact on adolescents because it promotes unhealthy social comparison, facilitates cyberbullying, and disrupts critical sleep patterns.

Another Example in Action

Let's apply the formula to a different subject.

- **Topic:** Distance learning
- **Claim:** offers more flexibility than traditional education
- **Rationale:** because it allows students to learn at their own pace, reduces commute time, and provides access to a wider range of courses.

Final Thesis Statement:

Distance learning provides greater flexibility than traditional classroom education by allowing students to learn at their own pace, eliminating commutes, and offering access to a diverse array of online courses.

By following this formula and diagram, you can ensure your thesis statement is specific, arguable, and provides a clear roadmap for your entire essay.

Example: From Bad to Good

Let's see how the formula transforms a weak thesis into a strong one.

Weak Thesis Statement:

- "This essay is about video games and violence."
- **Why it's weak:** It only states the topic; it has no claim or rationale. It is not debatable.

Applying the Formula:

1. **Topic:** Violent video games
2. **Claim:** do not cause real-world violence
3. **Rationale:** because they provide a safe outlet for aggression, most players can distinguish between fantasy and reality, and other factors like home environment are better predictors of violent behaviour.

Strong Thesis Statement:

"Despite common concerns, violent video games (Topic) do not cause real-world violence (Claim) because they offer a safe outlet for aggression, most players distinguish between fantasy and reality, and underlying environmental factors are more significant predictors of behaviour (Rationale)."

Lesson 6.2: Thesis Statements for Different Essay Types

第二课：不同文章类型的论文陈述 (Bùtóng wénzhāng lèixíng de lùnwén chénnshù)

The type of essay you are writing changes the way you frame your thesis. The **command word** in the prompt (from Chapter 3) is your guide.

你写的文章类型改变了你构建论文陈述的方式。提示中的**指令词**（来自第三章）就是你的指南。

Essay Type 文章类型	What the Thesis Does 论文陈述的作用	Key Words in Thesis 论文陈述中的关键词	Example 例子
Argumentative 议论文	Takes a debatable position and tries to persuade the reader. 采取一个可辩论的立场并试图说服读者。	should, must, ought to, despite, although 应该, 必须, 尽管	"Despite claims of economic benefit, plastic water bottles <i>should</i> be banned <i>because</i> they are a major source of pollution

Essay Type 文章类型	What the Thesis Does 论文陈述的作用	Key Words in Thesis 论文陈述中的关键词	Example 例子
			and their production wastes valuable resources."
Comparative 比较类文章	Highlights key similarities and/or differences between two subjects. 强调两个主题之间主要的相似点和/或不同点。	whereas, while, both, however, compared to 而, 虽然, 两者都, 然而, 与...相比	"While <i>both</i> classical and operant conditioning are learning processes, classical conditioning pairs stimuli <i>whereas</i> operant conditioning associates behaviour with consequences."
Analytical 分析类文章	Breaks down a text/idea to show how it works and what it means. 分解一个文本/想法以展示其工作原理和含义。	by examining, through, reveals, demonstrates 通过检验, 通过, 揭示, 展示	"In 'The Great Gatsby,' Fitzgerald <i>reveals</i> the corruption of the American Dream <i>by examining</i> the empty lives of the wealthy elite."
Problem-Solution 问题解决类文章	Clearly defines a problem and proposes a viable solution. 清晰定义一个问题并提出一个可行的解决方案。	problem, solution, to address, to solve, effective way 问题, 解决方案, 为解决, 为解决, 有效方法	"The <i>problem</i> of food waste in restaurants can be <i>solved</i> by implementing composting programs and offering variable portion sizes for customers."

Part 1: Practice: Identify the Type

练习：识别类型 (Liànxí: Shíbié lèixíng)

Instructions 说明: For each thesis statement below, identify which essay type it is best suited for: **Argumentative (A), Comparative (C), Analytical (An), or Problem-Solution (PS).**

对于下面的每个论文陈述，判断它最适合哪种文章类型：**议论文 (A), 比较类文章 (C), 分析类文章 (An), 或问题解决类文章 (PS)。**

- "The key difference between introverts and extroverts lies not in their social skills but in how they recharge their mental energy."
“内向者和外向者之间的主要区别不在于他们的社交技能，而在于他们如何补充心理能量。”
• **Type 类型:** _____
- "To reduce traffic congestion, the city must invest in reliable public transportation and create more bike lanes."
“为了减少交通拥堵，市政府必须投资可靠的公共交通并建设更多自行车道。”
• **Type 类型:** _____
- "Shakespeare's 'Macbeth' uses the symbolism of blood to represent the inescapable guilt that consumes Macbeth and Lady Macbeth after their murderous actions."
“莎士比亚的《麦克白》使用血的象征来代表麦克白和麦克白夫人谋杀行为后吞噬他们的无法逃避的负罪感。”
• **Type 类型:** _____
- "Although both are popular streaming services, Netflix focuses on a vast library of licensed content while Disney+ leverages its powerhouse proprietary franchises."
“虽然两者都是流行的流媒体服务，但Netflix专注于庞大的授权内容库，而Disney+则利用其强大的自有特许经营权。”
• **Type 类型:** _____

Lesson 6.3: Crafting and Refining Your Thesis

第三课：构建和完善你的论文陈述 (Gòujiàn hé wánshàn nǐ de lùnwén chéngshù)

Part 1: The Thesis Generator

论文陈述生成器 (Lùnwén chéngshù shēngchéng qì)

Use this template to draft your own thesis statement.

使用这个模板来起草你自己的论文陈述。

1. **My general topic is:** 我的大致主题是：

(e.g., school uniforms, renewable energy, a book you read)

(例如：校服，可再生能源，你读的一本书)

2. **My specific angle/position is:** 我的具体角度/立场是：

(What do you want to say about it? Try using a command word: I want to argue that.../compare.../analyse...)

(你想就此说些什么？尝试使用一个指令词：我想论证.../比较.../分析...)

3. **Because of these key reasons:** 因为以下关键理由：

• a) _____

• b) _____

• c) _____

(These will become the topics of your body paragraphs!)

(这些将成为你主体段的主题！)

4. **Now, combine it into one sentence:** 现在，将其组合成一个句子：

Task

Create 5 Strong Thesis statements. Each using a different Essay Type.

Part 2: The "So What?" Test (Again!)

“那又怎样？”测试（再来一次！）（“Nà yòu zěnyàng?” cèshì (zài lái yī cì!))

A good thesis must pass the test. Ask yourself: **"So what?"** Why does your argument matter? If the answer is obvious and important, you have a strong thesis.

一个好的论文陈述必须通过这个测试。问自己：“那又怎样？”为什么你的论点重要？如果答案是显而易见且重要的，那么你就有了一个强大的论文陈述。

- **Weak Thesis 薄弱论文陈述:** "People should exercise." (So what? This is obvious and boring.)

“人们应该锻炼。”（那又怎样？这显而易见且无聊。）

- **Strong Thesis 强大论文陈述:** "Implementing a mandatory 30-minute daily exercise period in workplaces would significantly reduce healthcare costs for employers and improve overall employee productivity and well-being." (This matters because it affects money and health!)

“在工作场所实施强制性的每日30分钟锻炼时间将显著降低雇主的医疗成本，并提高员工的整体生产力和幸福感。”（这很重要，因为它影响金钱和健康！）

Apply the test to the thesis you just wrote: 对你刚写的论文陈述应用这个测试：

- **So what? Why does your argument matter?** 那又怎样？为什么你的论点重要？

Homework: The Thesis Workshop

作业：论文陈述工作坊 (Lùnwén chénnshù gōngzuò fāng)

Task 1: Analyse 分析

Find two thesis statements online (in sample essays or articles). For each one:
在网上找两个论文陈述（在范文或文章中）。对每一个：

1. Identify the **topic**, **position**, and **rationale**.
找出**主题**、**立场**和**理由**。
2. Decide what **type of essay** it would fit.
判断它适合哪种**文章类型**。
3. Run it through the "**So What?**" test.
用“**那又怎样？**”测试来检验它。

Thesis 1: _____

- **Topic:** _____
- **Position:** _____
- **Rationale:** _____
- **Essay Type:** _____
- **So What?** _____

Thesis 2: _____

- **Topic:** _____
- **Position:** _____
- **Rationale:** _____
- **Essay Type:** _____
- **So What?** _____

Task 2: Create 创造

Using the **Thesis Generator** from this chapter, write **three** different thesis statements for **three** different essay types (Argumentative, Comparative, Analytical) on topics of your choice.

使用本章的**论文陈述生成器**，就你自选的主题，为**三种**不同的文章类型（议论文、比较类、分析类）写出**三个**不同的论文陈述。

1. (**Argumentative 议论文**) _____
2. (**Comparative 比较类文章**) _____
3. (**Analytical 分析类文章**) _____

Task 3: Refine 完善

Choose your strongest thesis statement from Task 2. Ask a peer or use an AI tool (e.g., "critique this thesis statement: [paste your thesis]") to get feedback. Revise it to make it clearer and more specific.

从任务2中选择你最强大的论文陈述。请一位同学或使用AI工具（例如：“评价这个论文陈述：[粘贴你的论文陈述]”）获取反馈。修改它，使其更清晰、更具体。

- **Original 原句:** _____
- **Feedback 反馈:** _____
- **Revised 修改后:** _____

Homework: The Thesis Workshop - Grading Rubric & Example

This assignment is a **Coursework Assessment**. It will be graded and contribute to your overall **Coursework**.

Grading Rubric for this Assignment

This homework will be graded on a scale of **0-10 points**. The total points from this assignment will contribute to your monthly coursework portfolio (e.g., under "November"). The rubric below details how your work will be evaluated across the three tasks.

Criteria	Excellent (9-10 pts)	Good (7-8 pts)	Satisfactory (5-6 pts)	Needs Improvement (0-4 pts)
Task 1: Analyse	Both thesis statements are expertly deconstructed. All components (topic, position, rationale) are correctly and insightfully identified. Essay type is perfectly matched, and the "So What?" test is answered with clear, logical reasoning.	Thesis statements are correctly deconstructed. Most components are accurately identified. Essay type is correct, and the "So What?" test is answered adequately.	Thesis statements are partially deconstructed, but some components are incorrect or missing. Essay type may be misidentified. The "So What?" answer is vague or illogical.	Analysis is incomplete, inaccurate, or demonstrates a lack of understanding of thesis components.
Task 2: Create	Three distinct, well-formed, and arguable thesis statements are provided. Each perfectly matches its designated essay type (Argumentative, Comparative, Analytical) and demonstrates a clear understanding of each form's purpose.	Three good thesis statements are provided that match their essay types. They are arguable but could be more specific or impactful.	Thesis statements are provided but are weak—they may be too broad, factual, or not properly tailored to the essay type.	Thesis statements are missing, completely off-topic, or do not function as arguable claims.
Task 3: Refine	The revision process is clear and effective. The feedback is thoughtfully Summarised, and the revised thesis is significantly improved—more specific, nuanced, and complex than the original.	The revision process is evident. Feedback is recorded, and the revised thesis is an improvement, addressing the feedback clearly.	A revision is attempted, but the changes are minimal or do not effectively address the feedback. The improvement is slight.	The task is incomplete, or the revised thesis is weaker than the original. Feedback is not recorded.

Example of a Completed Homework Assignment

Task 1: Analyse 分析

Thesis 1: *"The widespread adoption of renewable energy is not just an environmental imperative but a critical economic opportunity, as it can drive job creation in new technologies and foster energy independence."*

- **Topic:** Renewable energy adoption.
- **Position:** It is a critical economic opportunity.
- **Rationale:** It drives job creation and fosters energy independence.
- **Essay Type: Argumentative** (It aims to persuade the reader of a specific position).